Photo Rebel

Photo Rebel is a **complete** software solution for the Digital Photography enthusiast, amateur or pro, beginner or experimented.

- Non-Destructive Edits
- Complete 'Raw' Support
- MTP Camera Connexion
- Floating Point Editing and Image Processing
- Extensive Image Library Management
- 'Pro' Exports: file formats, borders, watermarks, signatures

Summary

Photo Rebel **connects** to your camera (or iPhone) and download the images you pick to your Personal Computer.

Photo Rebel **organizes** and classifies the images on your PC storage system, analyzing EXIF metadata, building a well and clearly structured photo library.

Photo Rebel is also able to **import** any images from any storage device, like a secondary disk or zip drive you might have, into your library.

Photo Rebel helps you to **browse** your library and easily find the images you are looking for.

Photo Rebel assists you with the somewhat 'painful' and time consuming process of **culling and rating** your photos.

Photo Rebel **edits** your photos providing advanced tools and a solid workflow designed with the help of professional photographers.

Photo Rebel **exports** your edited photos in the best size and format, for print, web publishing or gallery.

Photo Rebel can **sign and watermark** your photos: Customize borders, signature text, fonts, style, placement and colors.

Photos have been shot to be seen: The Photo Rebel **gallery** will showcase them: Full screen slide-show, Set images as Desktop Background.

Photo Rebel **speaks your language**: Localized by fluent and native (human) speakers to: French, Italian, Japanese, Spanish (partially - still in progress) and English. 10+ other languages are machine translated.

Camera Connection

Click the camera icon on the navigation bar on the left side to enter 'Camera' mode.

Connect your camera or iPhone via USB to your personal computer.
Thousands of camera model are supported. All MTP compatible devices will connect to Photo Rebel.

Important Notes:

Do not forget to turn your camera on or 'wake' it up, if needed.
iPhones need to be unlocked or else the connection will be rejected.

The User Interface should then display the name of the connected camera and the 'Begin Transfer' button should light up.
Launch the transfer and watch your photo being downloaded from your device, showing up as thumbnails in the main view.
Depending on how many images are stored on your camera, this may take a while.
Once all images have been downloaded or when you interrupt the transfer, you have the oportunity to bring them all in your library
or select some to ignore, or just pick a few to include in your library.

Once you are done with this selection process, you can optionally delete some or all images in the camera.

Important Note: Apple iPhone will NOT let Photo Rebel (or any other program) delete images or other files from your device.

If movie files or other files have been downloaded, you can switch to the corresponding view and repeat the same selection and delete process.

Photo Imports

Click the '+' icon on the navigation bar on the left side to enter 'Import' mode.
You can either drag and drop a folder (containing images) or a single image in the center area.

- Single Image

Photo Rebel loads the image, displays it and presents its metadata.
You can add it to your library or begin editing it, which will automatically add it to your library.
Much more on Editing later...

- Image Folder

Importing from a folder works similarly as importing from your camera, except that the images in the source folder are only copied, analyzed, and never deleted. It is up to you to delete these images, should you want to avoid having duplicates on your collections.

Your Library

Click the 'stack of photos' icon on the navigation bar on the left side to enter 'Library' mode.

Images added to your library, either imported or downloaded from your camera are classified by Year, Month and Day.
There are three dates of importance for Photo Rebel:
- Date of Capture : When the photo was shot.
- Date of Addition in your Library : When the photo was actually in your library.
- Date of Last Edit : When you edited the photo for the last time.

The library view top area let you select any combination of date kind with any choice of Year, Month and Day.
The library view then filters and shows the corresponding images.
Additionally, you can also filter using 'Stars' and 'Tags'.
More about these two concepts in the following sections.

Tagging

Tagging your photos with keywords, locations, and names is easy with Photo Rebel, it is also optional... But strongly recommended.

Each time an image is selected in the library, a larger thumbnail and its metadata is shown in the right panel, along with a 'Tags' section.
Clicking the button with a tag icon will let you edit the tags attached to that particular picture.

The Star System

With Photo Rebel the Star System is simple and straightforward:

- Zero Star: this photo has never been reviewed yet.

- One Star: Poor image, keep for now, but consider delete.
- Two Stars: Not so good.
- Three Stars: Not bad at all.
- Four Stars: A keeper.
- Five Stars: Gallery worthy photo, your best!

This rating system is very similar to what is available in almost all other photo editors.
Photo Rebel adds the following tweaks:

- Zero Star: This default rating is used when launching a culling process.

- Five Stars: Those images are automatically added to your 'Gallery'. (See corresponding section)

Each time an image is selected in the library, a larger thumbnail and its metadata is shown in the right panel, along with the 'Tags' section. Clicking the stars will let you change the rating given to that particular picture.

Culling

Click the 'stack of photos' icon on the navigation bar on the left side to enter 'Library' mode.
Choose the 'Added' filter at the top left, navigate the date buttons to find the photos you want to rate and cull.
Photos added on that day will show up as thumbnails. All photos there are all with zero stars, unrated.

Clicking "Rate and Cull" will launch the culling workflow.

Then Photo Rebel will ask you to define the tags that will be attached to all the photos you will
decide to keep. For example, if you are sorting the pictures of your recent road trip, you will possibly enter "Travel", "Summer", "California", "Yosemite".
No need to enter specific dates, as Photo Rebel is already doing that, and no need to enter an exact location if your camera records GPS locations.

While you are thinking about the tags and typing them, Photo Rebel loads in the background medium size versions of the photos in the current set.

Then you can select images in the "film strip" on the left side. Multiple selection is possible and three cases are possible:

Three or more images selected: Larger images are presented in a grid fashion, consider which ones to keep and / or which ones to reject.

Two images : Choose the one to keep, it will be given automatically one star and the other one will rejected
and removed from your library. The image you choose to keep is then shown in single image view.

Single image: In this view, you can add or remove stars, or even reject that photo, edit tags for this particular image.

You can also modify the set of tags automatically added during the culling process.

The Editing Workflow

All edits are non destructive. Each time you start editing your chenges are memorized by Photo Rebel. If interrupted, you can continue later exactly at the same point in the process.

Fixed Workflow

Photo Rebel offers a fixed editing workflow of successive steps, a bit like a Computer 'Wizard' process.
You can navigate Back and Next at will. Some steps can be skipped, just click 'Next'. If think your current choices in a given step are not so good, just click 'Reset' to start over.

Orientation and Mirroring

Some photos previously processed with other photo software sometimes are not presented correctly rotated. This step fixes that, if needed.

Additionally you have the option here to mirror the image as you see fit.

Straightening

You can rotate the image by very small angles to perfectly adjust the rotation of the image.
Drag over the image the vertical and horizontal guides to align with image features, such as buildings, the horizon, etc. and then rotate accordingly.

Touch Up

Photo Rebel helps you eliminate small defects from your photos, typically a lens flare or a little skim blemish.

- Click on the image to point the spot where a ‘patch’ is needed. A RED circle should appear there
- SHIFT-Click again on the image to provide a the location of the ‘patch’. A GREEN circle should appear there. The two circle should not overlap.
- Use the slider to make both circles as small as possible, while still covering the area to patch.
- Click the Patch button.
- Use the Reset button to start over with different locations, if needed.

Composition / Framing / Cropping

Drag over the image the external lines on the sides of the image to define a crop. Select in the combo-box the composition guide lines that should help you figure out the most harmonious composition. It defaults to the 'classic' rule of thirds.

De-noising

The de-noising filter is designed to reduce the image 'grain' and digital noise in low light scenes or high ISO shots. You should use only when truly needed, as this filter introduces some blur and may degrade a well-lit photo.

Avoid using this filter for portraits.

Global Exposure

- Shift: Add some absolute additive 'brightness' to all pixels of the image.

- Gain: Multiply 'brightness' to all pixels of the image.

- Gamma: Adjust exposure following a 'gamma' power curve, and more effective in the shadows and mid-tone areas.

This three settings 'work' together and are applied to the entire image.

Highlights and Shadows

Selectively adjust exposure for highlights and shadows areas of the image.

Selective Exposure

Selectively adjust exposure on the sides of the image. Creates gradients of luminosity over the image.

Spotlight

This effect creates a circular or elliptic area where luminosity is increased or decreased gradually.

White Balance

Photo Rebel offers three different ways to adjust White Balance. They work independently, choose one.

- Direct Color 'Temperature' adjustment.

- 'Gray World': Works well for very colorful images. You can adjust the saturation parameter of the algorithm.

- White Patch: Click on the source image on an area that should be white or gray. If the area is bright enough, run the algorithm.

Global Contrast

- Contrast: Increase contrast for all the image.

- Blur: Soften a bit the application of the contrast.

- Brightness: Can compensate for some loss of brightness when applying contrast.

This three settings 'work' together and are applied to the entire image.

For more precise adjustments, you can instead adjust contrast on each color channel independantly using the 'S-Curve' sliders.

Color Grading with Lookup Tables

Choose a LUT to apply to the entire image, either by dropping one cube file in the drop zone or by picking one in the combo-box.

You can also run the 'LUT Explorer': Photo Rebel will apply all LUTs in your collection and let you choose

one, or not.

Manual Color Grading

You can also adjust colors by either:

- Increase or decrease global color saturation.
- Use vibrance: Color vibrancy can be adjusted selectively on each color.

Sharpening

The sharpen effect is applied globally to the entire image. Excessive sharpening can be detrimental to image quality, increasing digital noise. After use, you should zoom in deep into the image to check for any potential 'damage' done.

Selective Desaturation

This effect allows to turn your photo into a Black and White shot, while keeping some hues fully colored. First click on the image to select a color. Adjust the sliders to tweak the strength of the effect to your liking and the specifics of the image.

Special Effects

In this final step of the editing 'wizard' you can pick a special filter in the combo-box and select an amount, the strength of the effect.

For example, the Grayscale filter will blend the original color image with a grayscale version of

it. A similar effect can be obtained with the 'Sepia' filter.

The “Hue Rotation” can create special and funny effects by rotating colors on the ‘Color Wheel’.

Review and Exports

Editing is complete and you can review the result of your edits: You compare side by side the final image and the original.

At this point you can also change the rating of image. Five Stars will add the image to your Gallery during the export process.

You can go back to make changes or decide to export: Photo Rebel will then create new images according to your selection of 'export formats'.

Photo Rebel ships with a few default export formats that you can edit in the 'Tools' area.

Borders, Signatures and Watermarks

In the 'Tools' area you can define and edit:

- Signatures: A short text that can be drawn on top of the exported image.

- Watermarks: A usually large text that will be drawn with transparency on top of the exported image.

- Export Formats: An export format combines:
- The size of the exported image.

- Its file format (Jpg, WebP, etc.) and when applicable the compression quality.
- Optionally, the border style you may wish to add around the image.
- Optionally, the signature to add on the image.
- Optionally, the watermark to add on top of the image.

A file format finally includes a file name postfix: This usually small but importantly unique sequence of characters will be appended to the image original file so that many image files can be created without overwrites.

Your Gallery

You gallery holds your very best photos: You can browse through then, launch a slide show and choose one that will become your desktop ‘wallpaper'.

Images rated five stars are automatically added to your gallery.